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A lesson learned in my life

The only sound in the cold dry air was my voice. With four experienced opponents and several serious judges, I felt nauseous.

In the English debate competition one month ago, I definitely wanted to quit, but ^{the} lesson that I learned five years ago supported me through. "Be comfortable being uncomfortable", the lesson that my team leader taught me ^{has lingered.} keeping lingering through all these years.

I still remember the time when I struggled against the thought of giving up in my first English debate tournament.

Whenever my excellent teammates spoke out their ideas with high English proficiency, I would hold back my tongue to avoid using my poor English. It seemed impossible to conquer the barrier of speaking in public in English and it wouldn't be possible to

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transform my attitude towards challenges if it hadn't been for my team leader's words.

Noticing my silence, my team leader came to me one night and shared her story of growing from a novice to ^a senior. Hearing that such an excellent debater had also gone through huge difficulties and how grateful she was for all those uncomfortable moments that pushed her to thrive, I was shocked. "Be comfortable being uncomfortable". The words left a lasting impression on me.

Picturing the scene where I confidently and fluently spoke with English, I decided to insist and see what would happen.

The rest of the time before the competition then witnessed me preparing thoroughly to face up ^{to} the challenge. Flashcards and sheets piling up, my confidence grew with sufficient

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preparation. Reluctant as I still was to use English during discussions, the words of my team leader kept reminding me to step out of my safe bubble however difficult it was.

Eventually, as we claimed the top spot on the podium, tears came flooding ^{down} to me and so did pride, for successfully facing ^{overcoming} up all those challenges.

which interview? Did you mention it?

It wasn't until the interview when I shared my thoughts

after the debate competition?

in English that I discovered ~~that I'd~~ the notable progress ^{I had made in} of my English. ~~Even~~ I realized that even if we didn't win,

A bit confusing here.

the suffocating moments were still worthy since it was the ^{you mentioned: you claimed the top spot on the podium}

challenges, the uncomfortable things that nourished me.

"Be comfortable being uncomfortable", which kept echoing in my mind, taught me a lesson of embracing challenges.

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From a novice speaker to an experienced debater, from a little girl who was afraid of challenges to someone who learned to embrace ^{them.} it, I transformed my attitude towards challenges and even created them consciously. Thanks to the lesson five years ago, I'm now a girl who knows ~~what~~ perceives challenges as a ~~step~~ chance ^{for} of growth.

well done!